

Helen : It is partly a **charity** school. You and I, and all the rest of us are charity children. I suppose you are an orphan. Aren't either your father or your mother dead?

Jane : Both died before I can remember.

Helen : Well, all the girls here have lost either one or both parents. This is called an institution for educating orphans.

Jane : Are you happy here?

Helen : You ask rather too many questions. I have given you answers enough for the present. Now I want to read. [Jane leaves Helen.]

[Spring has started. Semi-starvation and neglected colds had **predisposed** most of the students to receive infection. Forty five out of the eighty girls lay ill at one time. Helen is also ill. Jane goes to meet Helen in Miss. Temple's room.]

Jane : Helen, are you awake?

Helen : [Face is pale but **composed**.] Why have you come here, Jane? It is past 11 O' clock.

Jane : I have come to see you Helen. I have heard you are ill and I cannot sleep until I speak to you.

Helen : You have come to bid me good-bye. You are just in time probably.

Jane : Are you going home?

Helen : Yes, to my long home – last home.

Jane : No! No! Helen! But where are you going Helen? Do you know?

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